

Scientific Communication *Training*

A proposal for the COMMENCE programme | 1.5-day intensive workshop

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PREPARED FOR
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OVERVIEW

We propose a tailored version of our **Story Studio** programme, delivered as an intensive 1.5-day workshop for 10-12 cardiac surgeons at Edwards Lifesciences in Switzerland. Story Studio is highly interactive and practical, combining evidence-based communication principles with structured practice and constructive feedback. By the end of the training, participants will have presented multiple times, received detailed individual feedback, and will leave with a proven framework and digital tools to continue developing their skills. The training draws on Barbara Minto's **Pyramid Principle** and the data storytelling methodology of **Cole Nussbaumer Knaflic**.

With the COMMENCE trial's seminal 10-year data now published, there is a real opportunity to help your emerging surgical leaders communicate that evidence with clarity and the patient impact behind it. In our experience, when a scientific expert fails to connect with an audience, it is rarely a failure of the science. **It is the communication.**

PROGRAMME

Participants complete pre-work two weeks before the course: a **confidence survey**, a **lay abstract** of their research or a dataset from the COMMENCE trial, and **3-5 slides** on their chosen topic.

Day 1 covers four sessions across a full day. We begin with **Language** (90 min), exploring how visual, emotional, and logical language transform a clinical message, with paired exercises and group feedback. **Story** (90 min) introduces repeatable narrative frameworks and creative techniques including "prisming" the COMMENCE data from different stakeholder perspectives: surgeon, referring cardiologist, hospital administrator, patient. After lunch, **Presenting with Data** (90 min) focuses on the Pyramid Principle in practice, slide design, and the behaviour change framework. Participants restructure their own slides and present. The day closes with **On Camera and Delivery** (75 min), covering presence, voice, and a 60-second on-camera exercise with playback and individual feedback.

Day 2 (half day, close 12:30) is the final session: **Bringing It All Together**. Each participant delivers a full 5-7 minute presentation to the group, receiving structured peer feedback, detailed individual trainer feedback, and an on-camera recording for personal review.

POST-TRAINING SUPPORT

All participants receive 12 months' access to the **Story Studio Portal**, which includes AI-powered communication tools trained on the Story Studio methodology, a structured **Content Tool** for planning future presentations, course materials, and **30-day email support**. Whipsmart Media will provide a post-course survey measuring changes in communication confidence and a **summary report** identifying participants who demonstrated particular aptitude for communicating clinical evidence, with recommendations for follow-up activities.

We strongly recommend that Edwards plans a **tangible follow-up activity** for participants shortly after the course, such as a recorded video, an internal panel, or an opportunity to present at an upcoming event. This significantly increases the long-term impact of the programme.



Context, Delivery & *Investment*

EDWARDS LIFESCIENCES CONTEXT

This programme has been designed to support Edwards Lifesciences' commitment to **advancing clinical education and evidence dissemination**. With the publication of the COMMENCE trial's 10-year data, there is a clear need to ensure that the surgeons closest to this evidence can communicate its significance effectively to peers, institutions, and the broader clinical community. We tailor each session to address the specific challenges of the COMMENCE data, the pan-European group dynamics, conference and event readiness, and the varied skill levels within the cohort. The programme frames communication improvement as a universal life skill, not a competition, creating a safe and productive learning environment where **every participant improves from their own starting point**.

DELIVERY

Jonathan McCrea, Whipsmart Media, will design and deliver all sessions. A 1-hour briefing call will be held in advance to align on objectives, discuss compliance considerations, and finalise the agenda. Participants will receive a course handbook, Content Tool template, and access to the Story Studio AI portal. The workshop is designed for **10-12 participants** and will be held at **Edwards Lifesciences headquarters, Switzerland**, early summer 2026. We have extensive experience in the **medical device and pharmaceutical sectors**, including MSL training for Pfizer, and have worked with Edwards Lifesciences previously at your Limerick facility and in Dublin.

INVESTMENT

Programme Design	Consultation, briefing, customisation, survey design, compliance review, reporting	€2,500
Training Delivery	1.5-day workshop (3 half-day sessions x €4,500)	€13,500
Travel Days	2 half-days at 1/3 session rate (€1,500 x 2)	€3,000
Portal Access	12 licences, 12 months (valued at €200/participant)	Included

Total €19,000

PAYMENT

25% on signing of contract, 75% upon completion.

VALIDITY

60 days from date of issue.

TRAVEL

Flights, accommodation, transport billed separately at cost.

VAT

Not applicable. Services supplied outside the EU.